

our mandatory expenses were taken care of (e.g. the mortgage, child care, groceries, etc.) we would then determine what we had left to spend on discretionary expenses (restaurants, kid activities, etc.). The shift in focus on saving and investing first as a priority allowed us to reach our goals of saving that amount of money over that two-year time period.

Q. How did you decide where to invest this money?

A. We wanted to max out all of our tax-advantaged retirement options first to save on taxes. My husband has access to two pre-tax retirement accounts as a teacher, a 403(b) and a 457(b), and I had access to a 401(k) through my job. We then maxed out our Roth IRA via the backdoor Roth IRA strategy, which basically allowed us to convert our traditional IRA to a Roth IRA. After maxing out all of our tax-advantaged accounts, we did taxable investing via index funds in non-retirement accounts. We chose index funds because they are simple and have low fees. I wanted to be able to invest on autopilot and not have to pick individual stocks or make things too complicated. Ultimately, we went for the most simple and low-fee options we could find.

Q. What are some of your long-term investing goals and how are you ensuring you achieve them?

A. Long-term we want to make sure that we have enough money invested to cover us in our standard retirement years where we won't have to actively work if we don't want to. Right now, we are on track to have enough saved and invested. We made sure we could achieve that by aggressively investing in previous years so that our money would have more time to compound over time. Since we are long-term investors and don't plan to tap into our tax-advantaged investments any time soon, we are comfortable with keeping our money in mostly equity index funds and riding out any market dips. As we get closer to our standard retirement years, we will adjust our portfolio as necessary.

Q. You have a busy life as a wife, mother, and entrepreneur; what are some tips you used to simplify your investing approach when you were just starting out?